
Marcela Sánchez Vargas | Founding Campus Director Candidate
Strategic Partnerships | Operations | Data-Driven Leadership

This dossier provides evidence of my capability to lead high-level governance structures, ensure rigorous institutional compliance, and represent organizations in top-tier international forums creating a strong network of collaboration. My experience focuses on the **nexus of science, policy, and administration**, specifically within the German-Colombian cooperation framework.

Demonstrating fiscal responsibility and transparency for international boards.

- ## GENERAL ASSEMBLY

March 2021

DEVELOPMENT PLAN

2020 - 2030

Strategy A.

Establish a vision and a common strategy services and strategic projects for CEMarim Corporation

Strategy B.

Develop international and network activities to increase national and international visibility

Strategy C.

Establish University Institute of the CEMarim Corporation

ADMINISTRATIVE TEAM

In 2021, a new team made its implementation of the Corporation's strategy with the advice of the legal firm. The changes were shared with the members of the Board of Directors and new members were proposed. Taking their suggestions into account.

We increased our income by 70% compared to 2020, and diversified our income sources through the management and administration of marine protected areas.

The organizational chart of the CEMarim Corporation was reorganized and awarded to include new posts and areas necessary for the growth of the Corporation.

The CEMarim Innovation and Entrepreneurship Unit was created, and we participated in the European Network of Research and Innovation Centres, and held in Latin America and the Caribbean - AMERCON IAC.

We strengthened our international network with institutions such as Traqueya, Schepelers, Corrent, the SOGEMA network, Cornell University and UNCP Helms.

Year	Income (€)
2020	~150,000
2021	~750,000
2022	~900,000

FUNDRAISING AND PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Throughout the year, searches for national calls were undertaken through the publication of the SOGMA Bulletin of the Universidad Nacional de Colombia, the website, and social networks of Mexico City and the various cities, and the investment, and in the middle of the year, the search began through the Fleet and Horizon Marine Alliance.

Support for researchers in the preparation of proposals to apply to national and international calls, and the adjustment of costing proposals to be applied to international calls.

22 project applications submitted to national and international calls. 8 applied researchers from all the institutions that make up the AMERCON IAC.

- Technology, infrastructure, data and modeling
 - Marine environmental change
 - Ecosystems
 - Ecosystems, technology, infrastructure, data and modeling
 - Marine resources - ocean and society

Design and monitoring of the course: biogeographic basins and vector resources, taught by CEMarim researchers from the UNAL and UNAL. Support for the coordination of the project management policy and the development plan, among other activities.

RESULTS

RESULTS

Executive Management Report 2021. Source: CEMarin Annual Board Report. **Date:** 2018–2021. **Key Metric:** Total management of €500k+ in international funds.

High-level financial governance: Translating complex operational data into strategic insights for international stakeholders.

II. THOUGHT LEADERSHIP & INTERNATIONAL REPRESENTATION

Validating my role as a Subject Matter Expert in the German-LAC academic ecosystem.

- [DAAD 10 Years of the Excellence Centers Workshop \(Berlin, 2019\)](#): Selected as a **Strategic Panelist & Rapporteur**. I was responsible for synthesizing and reporting findings on transnational education cooperation to an audience of experts from **Heidelberg University** and the **German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD)**.
- [DAAD Webinar: Digital Formats \(2020\)](#): Featured speaker on the digitalization of international higher education. I presented strategies for "Digital Formats in International Projects," focusing on how to measure success in virtual cooperation environments—a precursor to the modern campus needs of KLU.



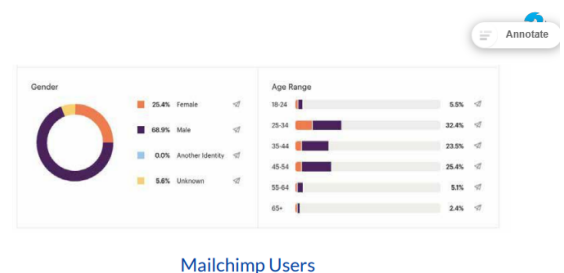
CEMarin
Corporate Center of Excellence
in Marine Sciences

DAAD Webinar: Digital formats in international Higher Education projects

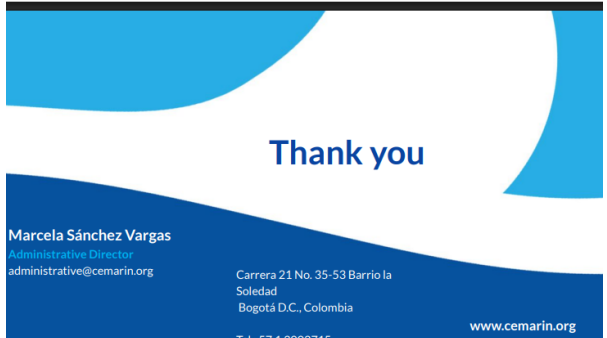
July 2020

Research Cooperation at CEMarin:
Diversifying our communication strategy

1. [Who we are?](#)
2. [International Conferences and Research Cooperation online](#)
3. [Diversifying our communication strategy](#)
4. [How to measure the success of the strategy](#)



Mailchimp Users



Thank you

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Marcela's Presentation for the DAAD [Webinar: Digital Formats](#) Source: Official DAAD Excellence Center Documentation (Berlin).

Role: Strategic Rapporteur / Subject Expert.

Strategic Liaison: Bridging German academic standards with Latin American operational execution.

III. INTERNATIONAL MANDATES (EU-LAC COOPERATION) & STRATEGIC FUNDRAISING OVERSIGHT

Ensuring institutional readiness for high-level German federal grants.

- **The ColombiaConnect Landmark (€1M Grant):** I led the strategic coordination and administrative oversight that allowed CEMarin to host and execute the **ColombiaConnect** project.
 - **Institutional Foundation:** This €1,000,000 grant from the German Federal Ministry of Education and Research (**BMBF**) was awarded based on the operational excellence and proven track record of CEMarin during my administration.
 - **Strategic Partnership:** I coordinated the institutional alignment with the **University of Giessen (JLU)**, who spearheaded the technical proposal, ensuring that CEMarin met all the rigorous financial and legal requirements to manage the funds.
 - **Financial Impact:** My management of this mandate resulted in a direct injection of **€250,000** into CEMarin's budget and was a key factor in the **76% revenue growth** recorded in 2021.
 - **Consortium Leadership:** Orchestrated the operational synergy between the JLU Giessen, the **Senckenberg Society**, and the **Fraunhofer Institute (IME)**.



Logo of ColombiaConnect / BMBF / JLU Giessen Source: Official Project Documentation. **Role:** Strategic Coordination & Institutional Management.

Strategic Stewardship: Providing the institutional framework and administrative excellence required to secure and manage million-euro German federal grants."

Proven track record in Horizon 2020 and bi-regional R&D projects.

- **Horizon 2020 - EU-LAC NCP (Barbados, 2015):** Acted as the National Contact Point during the high-level ALCUE NET sessions. I coordinated with European ambassadors and research leaders to align the regional R&D agenda.
- **ENSOCIO-LAC Project (Berlin, 2015):** Responsible for technical deliverables and strategic outputs. My role was to ensure that the project's milestones met the strict requirements of the European Commission.



Twitter Screenshot of the ENSOCIO-LAC Closing Workshop in Berlin Source: [Official ENSOCIO Project Feed](#).

Evidence: Visible participation in the final technical sessions as a key deliverable owner.

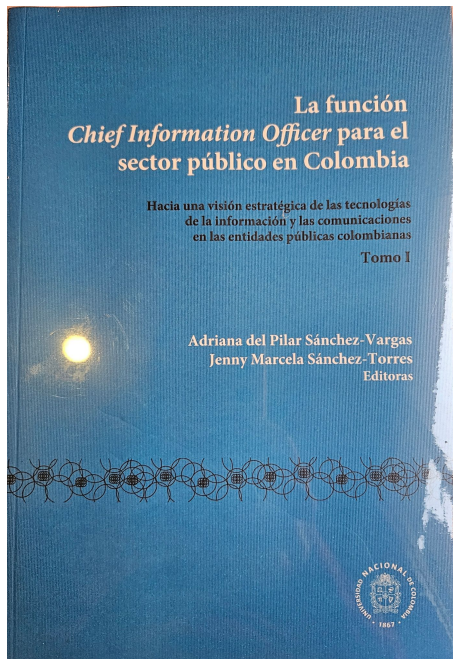
Global Networking: Direct engagement with European Commission stakeholders and international R&D consortia."

IV. STRATEGIC RESEARCH & POLICY BENCHMARKING

Analytical depth applied to Digital Governance and Public Administration.

- **Key Publication:** *"International Benchmarking: Digital Government & the CIO Function."*
- **Context:** This research was developed under a **Special Cooperation Agreement** (Convenio Especial de Cooperación). I served as a **Co-author** within a high-level multidisciplinary team of experts and academics from Universidad Nacional de Colombia.
- **Scope:** The study synthesized multiple phases of research to define the implementation model for the Government Chief Information Officer (GCIO) function in Colombia, based on international best practices.
- **Strategic Value:** Demonstrates my ability to work within complex institutional frameworks and contribute mathematical and operational expertise to national-level digital transformation strategies.

Full Academic Citation: Sánchez-Torres, J. M., Sánchez-Vargas, A. P., ... **Sánchez-Vargas, M.**, et al. (2014). *Chapter 3: Results and Synthesis of the CIO Function Implementation*. In: Strategic Model for the IT Management Function. Derived from the Special Cooperation Agreement.



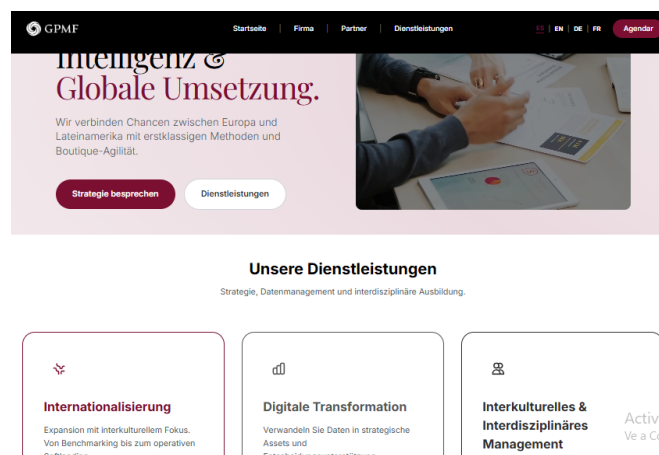
Source: Private Institutional Repository.

Analytical Precision: Applying mathematical and benchmarking methodologies to public policy and digital governance.

V. STRATEGIC BRANDING & DIGITAL ARCHITECTURE

End-to-end creation of institutional identity and digital presence.

- **Brand Foundations (CEMarin & GPMF):** I designed and executed the complete branding strategy for both organizations, ensuring a professional, world-class image aligned with international academic and business standards.
- **Web Development & Deployment:** I led the full lifecycle of the institutional websites, from conceptual wireframing and content strategy to technical launch and maintenance.



GPMF Website Homepages Source: [GPMF Website](#) **Role:** Creative Director & Web Architect. **Tech Stack:** Github Pages & Windsurf

- **Multimedia Direction:** I built and coordinated communications teams to produce high-impact institutional videos and "Highlights." My role was to ensure **narrative consistency and strategic alignment** for international donor engagement and board reporting.

Selected Portfolio: Institutional Brand Direction

Strategic storytelling directed to translate complex missions into engaging digital experiences.

- **"¿Qué es el CEMarin?" (Institutional Identity)**
 - *Role:* Executive Producer / Creative Direction.
 -  [\[Watch Video: CEMarin Institutional Profile\]](#)
- **"Lanzamiento Colombia Connect" (Program Launch)**
 - *Role:* Strategic Coordination & Launch Oversight.
 -  [\[Watch Video: Colombia Connect Launch Highlights\]](#)
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- Strategic Positioning: Building digital ecosystems that translate complex organizational missions into engaging, high-conversion brand experiences."
- **Institutional Branding:** Produced high-impact institutional videos and "Highlights" for international conferences, ensuring that the organizations I led maintained a "World-Class" brand image. you tube selection of Brand building in YouTube

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